

Chapter 1: Literature Review

Introduction

Overview of the topic

Intro to correctional rehabilitation and the issue of recidivism among emerging adults (18-26).

Brief background on developmental stages and criminogenic risk factors relevant to young offenders.

Contextual Background

Discuss U.S. correctional trends, incarceration rates, and reoffending statistics for young adults.

Emphasize the need for age-responsive programming.

Relevance to forensic psychology and correctional practice

Link between psychological interventions (CBT, schema therapy, etc.) and behavioral change.

Purpose of the program development

Introduce the aim of the program development: to foster desistance through a theoretically integrated intervention for emerging adults in a residential facility, with emphasis on strengths, identity development, and structured evidence-based interventions.

Organization of the chapter

Preview the sections that are coming after (e.g., theory, criminogenic factors, desistance literature, intervention models, program development rationale).

Be sure to include the problem statement at the end of this section. Focus on the limited availability of evidence-based, developmentally tailored, strengths-oriented rehabilitation programs that promote desistance among young adult offenders in residential/correctional settings.

2. Theoretical Foundations

Overview of theoretical frameworks in correctional psychology

Importance of theory-driven programming in offender rehabilitation.

Theories of criminal behavior

Social learning theory

General strain theory

Cognitive behavioral theory foundations

Look in the psychology of criminal conduct book to get a few more

Desistance theories

Maturation theory

Life-course criminology

Find others ones from references already picked out

Schema theory

Jeffery young's schema therapy principles

Maladaptive schemas commonly seen in offender populations (e.g., mistrust/abuse, defectiveness, entitlement)

Integration of theories

How strengths-based and psychologically informed interventions can support desistance

Also talk about the theoretical model guiding this dissertation, including positive psychology, desistance theory, and rehabilitation models relevant to emerging adults

3. Understanding the population: young adult offenders

Defining the age group

Developmental psychology of emerging adulthood

Cognitive, emotional, and social characteristics

Brain development and impulsivity

Identity formation and peer influence

Criminogenic risk factors common to young adults

Substance dependence, unemployment (kind of talked about this in research methods so pull those references), antisocial peers, trauma, family dysfunction, the list goes on

Challenges in correctional environments

Theres so much here (pull reference that already have)

Institutionalization effects, lack of developmental programming, resistance to treatment, the list goes on

4. Desistance from crime

Conceptualizing desistance

Primary, secondary, and tertiary desistance

Factors that promote desistance

Cognitive/identity shifts, social bonds, employment, education, treatment engagement, and strengths-based development.

Gender and age considerations in desistance

How desistance differs across age and sex

Empirical studies on desistance interventions

Summarize key findings and methodologies

Limitations in the current desistance literature

Gaps in programs specifically tailored to young adults in correctional settings

Also talk about how the field barely agrees on a set in stone definition and how to measure it. Pull references already have

5. Correctional rehabilitation models, positive psychology, and the rationale for an integrated strengths-based intervention

Evolution of correctional rehabilitation

Shift from punitive approaches to rehabilitative paradigms

May briefly mention relevant case law or policy trends if useful, but keep it concise

Major rehabilitation frameworks

The risk-need-responsivity (RNR) model

The good lives model (GLM)

Position GLM as a central framework for this dissertation because of its emphasis on strengths, human goods, and prosocial identity development

Positive psychology and offender rehabilitation

Define positive psychology and explain how its emphasis on strengths, meaning, well-being, hope, and flourishing connects to desistance

Explain why a strengths-based framework is especially relevant for emerging adults in residential settings

Evidence-based interventions in correctional settings

CBT

DBT

Schema therapy

Motivational interviewing (MI)

Mention any other major interventions only if clearly relevant

Effectiveness of correctional interventions

Use meta-analyses to summarize the evidence efficiently

Emphasize the effectiveness and limitations of these interventions with offender populations

Include a couple of methodologically different studies for diversity

Programmatic elements that predict success

Treatment dosage

Therapeutic alliance

Aftercare and continuity of care

Staff training, fidelity, and responsiveness

Strengths-based and identity-oriented intervention rationale

Explain why the proposed intervention should promote desistance through strengths, identity development, and structured interventions

Connect positive psychology, GLM, and desistance theory here

Explain how structured interventions can support identity transformation and long-term behavior change in emerging adults

Trauma-informed care

Incorporating trauma awareness within the broader integrated framework

Include research and prevalence/base-rate information on trauma in justice-involved or correctional populations compared to non-clinical populations

Explain why trauma can block treatment progress and desistance if left unaddressed

Cultural and contextual responsiveness

Accounting for cultural identity, SES background, and systemic/systemic barriers

Connect this directly to the proposed intervention so the program is not one-size-fits-all

Challenges and limitations in correctional/residential programming

Institutionalization effects

Lack of developmental programming

Resistance to treatment

Lack of individualized and developmentally appropriate content for emerging adults (18-26)

6. Program development framework

7. Program development framework

Evidence based program design principles

Needs assessment and target population specificity

Program goals and objectives

Which is to promote desistance, strengthen identity development, build on client strengths, improve coping mechanisms, and reduce recidivism risk

I will also check what the gap in the literature is within mental health treatment in correctional facilities to provide more information

Proposed structure of the program

Session format like individual/group, length, content areas

I will need to research what the typical number of sessions correctional facilities use when conducting treatment in these settings

The role of staff and facilitator competence

Training, fidelity monitoring, and supervision

Anticipated challenges in implementation

Institutional barriers, client resistance, staffing, and funding

8. Gaps in the literature and need for the proposed program

Summary of key findings

Synthesize the main literature themes (use clinicians thesaurus to look at how to speak succinctly when you have so much information)

Identify gaps in the literature within correctional facilities

Lack of developmentally informed, evidence-based desistance programs for 18-26 year old in corrections

Theoretical and practical contributions

How this proposed strengths-based, GLM-informed intervention fills empirical and applied gaps

9. Chapter summary

Recap major themes

Reaffirm the importance of addressing desistance through targeted, evidence-based programming

Review the chapter